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Q1 2025

Emerging Tech Indicator

June 25, 2025

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Top VC firms are ushering in the era of AI agents

With leading foundation models maturing, seed and early-stage investments by the top VC firms in Q1 consolidated around AI agents and the underlying infrastructure to deploy them. With these high-profile backers, emerging AI startups are well poised to usher in a new era of enterprise operations.

In Q1 2025, top VC firms closed the fewest seed and early-stage deals in a quarter since 2020 and 50% less than they did a year ago. However, with large bets on AI, alternative energy, and biotech, deal value remains elevated. In an analysis of all seed and early-stage investments by the world's most successful VC firms, the Emerging Tech Indicator reveals the products and technologies positioned to alter the venture landscape. This report breaks down what technologies these firms are funding and what it tells us about where venture is headed next.

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Other notable activity

Venture activity summary

ETI investor ranking

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